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the FM held steady and unleashed a spectacular capex war that sought to bring the economy on keel and provide jobs to a population traumatised by the horrors of a once-in-a-century pandemic. After presenting her fifth and last full Budget for the current government's tenure, the FM looked relaxed and assured as she held forth on her Budget initiatives at the India Today-Business Today Budget Roundtable on January 6 in New Delhi's posh ITC Maurya

hotel. The day-long programme, of which the FM's was the last and showstopping session, was graced by a long list of luminaries—including Union ministers, opposition leaders, finance ministry Secretaries who were instrumental in drafting the Budget, industry leaders and leading economists, among others. Attended by more than 200 top industry leaders, the programme provided a high degree of insight. Some highlights are given here for your perusal. **BT**

1. Aroon Purie, (left), Chairman and Editor-in-Chief, India Today Group, and Nirmala Sitharaman, Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs, unveil the special 31st Anniversary Issue of *Business Today*

INDIA'S ECONOMIC SUPERHIGHWAY

2. Rahul Kanwal, (left), News Director, India Today and Aaj Tak, and Executive Director, *Business Today*, with **Ashwini Vaishnaw,** Minister of Railways; Communication, Electronics and IT

» The construction work for India's first bullet train is happening at a very fast pace. Already 140 km of pillars have been cast, almost 28 km of girders have been laid, the bridges over all the eight rivers have reached deck level, and work is going on at all the 13 stations

» High-speed rail is not merely a transportation product. It makes big cities into one single economic zone for growth

» Semiconductors are vital for India's future. Electronics manufacturing was practically negligible 10 years ago. Close to \$87 billion of electronics manufacturing is happening in India now, and we are reaching almost \$9 billion in exports of mobile phones this year

» The government has contacted each and every participant of the chips ecosystem, and they have committed to come here

» There is a very strong, positive reaction by chip majors for India. The decision on fab applications will be announced in 14-16 months from the date of opening the bidding process

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